Chapter 4

Introduction to Ruby

Many people who are new to Rails are also new to Ruby. If you're familiar with a language such as Java, JavaScript, PHP, Perl, or Python, you'll find Ruby pretty easy to pick up.

This chapter isn't a complete introduction to Ruby. It doesn't cover topics such as precedence rules (as in most other programming languages, `1+2*3==7` in Ruby). It's only meant to explain enough Ruby that the examples in the book make sense.

This chapter draws heavily from material in *Programming Ruby* [FH13]. If you think you need more background on the Ruby language (and at the risk of being grossly self-serving), we'd like to suggest that the best way to learn Ruby and the best reference for Ruby's classes, modules, and libraries is *Programming Ruby* [FH13] (also known as the PickAxe book). Welcome to the Ruby community!